

Reasons for High or Low Population

The following factors affect the population of a region:

1. Geographical Factors

If the soil of any region is level, smooth and fertile then it is easier to populate it. Here production and the necessities of life through farming and gardening can easily be obtained. In such regions living, building houses, and getting the various requisites of life are much easier. Therefore, these regions are densely populated. Contrary to these, rugged areas, mountains, forests and land without water are most unsuitable for living, therefore, the population in such regions is extremely low.

2. Climate

Regions where the climatic conditions are good and the rain falls on time people stay healthy and work very hard. Food supply is in abundance. In the river valleys the soil is smooth, fertile and most suitable for agriculture. These regions, therefore, have high population. Ancient cities were settled near rivers. River valley of Nile in Egypt, river valley of Ganges and Jamuna, river valley of Indus in Pakistan and valleys of river Euphrates and Tigris in Iraq are some of the examples. Areas with temperate and slightly warm climate where there is rainfall are thickly populated. For example, the climatic region of Mediterranean Sea and the monsoon climatic region. Comparatively, areas of extreme cold and heat, equatorial forests and deserts regions are thinly populated.

3. Mineral Production

Those regions where valuable minerals are found for example, coal, iron, oil, gas or precious stones etc. such areas are densely populated as employment opportunities are high. Transportation facilities are also available in such regions. Factories and industries are also established near the regions where mineral wealth is found and big cities come into existence with large population.

4. Trade Routes

The population increases in the areas that are situated near trade routes. Apart from land routes sea and air routes also play an important role. Population also increases at places where there are harbours and airports.

5. Economic and Political Conditions

The areas where there is political stability and the people enjoy social freedom and economic prosperity have dense population. Sometimes due to religious and social reasons people move from one place to another as it happened during the partition of the sub-continent when millions of Muslims migrated from India and settled in Pakistan and millions of non-Muslim went to India. The creation of Israel brought millions of Jews in Palestine who forced Palestinians to vacate their areas and settle in neighbouring countries.

Population Growth in Pakistan

There has been a rapid increase in the population of the world. Pakistan is also among those countries where population is increasing. According to the census report of 1998, the population of Pakistan was 132.352 million. Currently it is estimated at 200 million. There is an annual increase of 2.1 per cent. This increase in population is dangerous because it would put heavy pressure on the resources of the country and many social, economic and ethical problems will arise. It is important to know that due to increase in population the demand for the necessities of life also increases. With the increase in population, if the production does not increase then a number of problems and difficulties have to be faced. Therefore, it is essential that a balance between the production and the population is maintained. We should try to make as much use of the available resources as possible so that the requirements of the growing population could be met. The new trends, which are emerging due to the increase in population, should be studied fully. They are as follows: -

1. Population Migration

After the Industrial Revolution migration of people from villages towards cities started mainly for better employment opportunities, education, health and for better standard of living.

As a country develops from an agricultural to an industrial economy, large-scale migration of rural residents to towns and cities takes place. During this process, the growth rate of urban population increases at double pace. About 29 per cent of the world population was living in urban areas in 1950; this figure was 43 per cent in 1990, and elevated to 50 per cent by the year 2005.

In developed nations such as Britain, Germany, Sweden, etc. almost 80 per cent of the total population lives in cities.

Urbanization eventually leads to a severe decline in the number of people living in the countryside, with negative population growth rate in the rural areas.



Over crowding in cities

In Pakistan and in the other countries of South Asia, the population influx is towards the urban areas from the rural areas. Most migrants to the cities can be assumed to have bettered themselves in comparison to their former standard of living, despite the serious problems of overcrowding, substandard housing, and inadequate municipal services that characterize life for many arrivals to urban centers. Dealing with these conditions, especially in very large cities, presents massive difficulties for the governments of less-developed countries.

If farming is developed in villages and farmers are provided with the latest equipments, better seeds, artificial manure and loans on easy installments then the production would increase. If they are provided with better food, good living conditions, education, electricity, water and medical facilities, transportation facilities then this population influx towards cities will stop.

Apart from this another problem is that of law and order, peace and stability. Due to increase in population different types of crimes are increasing. Corruption is also increasing which is affecting the social infrastructure. Therefore, it is necessary that by adopting different measures village population should not be allowed to move towards cities.



Slum area

2. Men and Women

Men and women are important constituents of any society. No society can prosper unless men and women are given equal opportunities for progress and development. In the present times the role of women in society is of great importance. Development is possible only when women are educated along with men. All around the world women are working side by side with men. Whether it is home or office or any other field of human activity, women are showing their talents. Like the other developing countries of the world, special attention is being given to the education of women in Pakistan as well.

It is worth remembering that at present the population of women is equal to men but they are mostly confined to their houses. The educational facilities available for them are few as compared to men. For keeping a healthy balance in society,

women need to be educated. It is necessary that women are given their due representation in every field of life. One woman creates one family and this is how a prosperous and civilized nation comes into existence. With the growing number of women in Pakistan there is a need for giving special attention to their problems.

3. Literacy Rate

At present in the world in general and in the developing countries in particular special attention is being given to increase the literacy rate. Looking to the literacy rate in the world a lot of efforts are being made to raise the literacy rate in our country because illiterate people are a burden on any society. Illiteracy gives rise to many social evils. Pakistan enjoys important position among the developing nations. In 1972 the literacy rate of Pakistan was 21 per cent (men 30 per cent and women 11 per cent). In 1981 with a little increase it became 26 per cent (men 35 per cent and women 16 per cent).

According to the census of 1998 the literacy rate of Pakistan was 45 per cent (men 61 per cent and women 36 per cent). As compared to the rest of the world, this increase in the literacy rate is not satisfactory.

The rate of literacy among the women in particular is very low and if it is compared with the increase in population then it is quite upsetting. Therefore, it is essential that for increasing the literacy rate not only the population should be controlled but urgent steps should be taken to increase the number of schools and open literacy centers. Provision of different facilities is made raising the standard of living of the people. The problems of health and cleanliness/hygiene should be solved. Best sources for raising the rate of literacy are private institutions and trusts which are engaged in social work at the national level. There is a need for giving legal protection to the infrastructure, the objectives and the working of these institutions and making them stronger.

4. Migration

The trend of migrating from one place to another is quite high. There are a number of reasons for this. Wars are taking place between various countries of the world and for their protection and safety people take shelter in the neighbouring countries. The people of underdeveloped and developing countries, for better facilities of life and for raising their standard of living, move from their countries and get settled

in other countries. The best example of this is the migration of people to USA, Canada and Britain. Apart from this, there is a trend of intermarriages among different people of the world. The various agencies of the United Nations are all engaged in settling the people in different parts of the world. People are moving to other parts of the world from the countries where there is corruption and instability.

Pakistan has a significant place in the world as far as migration is concerned. There has been political instability in Afghanistan, for the last 25 years. Due to civil wars and the Russian (former USSR) attack on Afghanistan, almost 3.5 million Afghans have migrated to Pakistan. This problem of migration is also of great concern for those countries where these immigrants have settled. The refugee problem can only be resolved if properly taken up on international level by maintaining peace in the area and providing aid to the refugees to go back to their homes and make proper arrangements for their rehabilitation.

Effects of Increase in Population

As our population keeps on growing there is a serious concern shown by experts that whether there will be enough land, agriculture, animals and livestock to support this growth of population. How will it affect our environment? These are the questions which we should ask ourselves. How many people can our planet support? No one really knows, but scientists do know, it can only support as many people as its resources can feed.

The world population was estimated to have reached 6 billion mark on October 12, 1999. Experts feel that if we keep on growing the way that we are, we will reach anywhere from 7.3 billion to 10.7 billion people. So, how many people can we feed? Most people would say that we just need to increase the food production. But how many crops we should grow? All this requires more land that we may not have. Every year we lose many acres of topsoil on farmland due to our farming practices. Some farming techniques damage the soil on large scale causing loss of nutrients with the result that it no longer supports a crop. The topsoil literally blows away. The United States itself loses about 3.5 acres of topsoil per person a year. If we increase the farmland or cattle land, we will be taking land away from the wildlife. With six billion people in the world and more to come, we will have a greater demand for geographic spread, demand for natural resources, and ways of disposing of wastes which will give a more direct cause for plant and animal extinction.

Though the future may sound grim, there are organizations that are working on this issue. Many organizations are coming up with the programmes to help educate people around the world about this issue and suggest the right choices. They are also working on the issue of women awareness. They are particularly educating the women about their reproductive health and offer helpful guidance to them in many areas for making better decisions.

The effects of increase in population on human resources

According to population Pakistan is the seventh largest country of the world. The total population of Pakistan is about 200 million. The increase in population has an effect on all fields of life. This increase in population creates the following problems:-

1. Residential Problems

According to the world standards, 'residence' means a house or a room where in not more than two people are living. The facilities of bathroom, kitchen, toilet, clean drinking water and facility of light are also available. There is proper arrangements for cleanliness and sewerage. Due to these facilities the environment of the house will be free from pollution. But the rapid growth in population affects the residential facilities. In Pakistan almost 1/3rd of the total population i.e. 32.5 per cent lives in well built houses whereas the rest of the population i.e. 67.5 per cent of the rural population lives in poorly made houses.

In Pakistan, due to the non-availability of necessary facilities the rural population is migrating to the urban areas. As this migration takes place without any proper planning, therefore, a number of problems arise in the urban areas. The following are the details of these problems:

1. Due to the fact that more than one person lives in a room, therefore, the living, growth, health and attitudes of people get badly affected.
2. The basic necessities of life decrease.
3. The environmental pollution increases.
4. Lack of cleanliness causes diseases.
5. The fertile land gets affected due to its growing use for residential purposes.
6. Deforestation for making construction material for the houses leads to decreasing the area under forests.
7. Due to the increase in urban population, the residential and educational facilities in the villages are not available according to the requirements.
8. Ethical problems and crimes increase and many social and economic problems arise.

9. With the increase in the means of transportation, pollution also increases as more motor vehicles ply on roads and emit smoke.

The only solution for overcoming these problems is to check the influx of rural people towards the urban areas. The basic facilities for health, education, cleanliness and recreation along with job opportunities are provided to the people in the rural areas.

2. The Problems of Transportation

The rural migration towards the urban areas has also created transportation. Many difficulties are being faced due to playing more motor vehicles on the roads problem. For example, buses, motorcars, motorcycles and trucks used for carrying heavy loads have increased the volume of traffic on the roads. The traveling has thus become slow. Emission of smoke by these vehicles also causes environmental pollution.

In Pakistan as the roads are not wide and made of good quality material, therefore, not only the distances are covered in a longer period of time but the rate of accidents has also increased. Everyday a number of precious lives are lost due to this. The arrangements for controlling the traffic are also insufficient. Therefore, there is a need for widening the roads. It should be guaranteed that traffic rules are properly followed. Apart from these, it is necessary that with the increase in traffic, some training programmes be arranged for developing traffic sense among the people.

3. The Problems of Health and Cleanliness

Health is most significant in human life. Only healthy human beings form a healthy society. Human health depends on balanced diet, clean environment, education and proper medical facilities. It is essential for good health that human beings get good food, proper clothing, fresh air and pollution free environment. If a person possesses good mental and physical health, then he does not fall victim to hopelessness and despair. But due to increase in population, the basic necessities of life are either not available or if available are not of good standards to the common man. Due to non-availability of proper food and nutrition, human beings are attacked by many diseases. Their efficiency also decreases. Similarly, if the surroundings near a house and inside the house are free from pollution, then it will have a good effect on human health. The conditions of health and hygiene are not satisfactory in Pakistan. Likewise, due to the non-availability of proper sewerage system people catch different diseases. Dust and smoke are obstacles in the way of getting clean and fresh air. Due to the absence of proper facilities for health and hygiene there has been a rapid increase

in the death rate of the newly born infants. The average age of people is also low as compared to other countries of the world. The following are the reasons for the low standard of living in Pakistan.

1. The rapid growth of population.
2. Low per capita income.
3. Low literacy rate.
4. Increase in the environmental pollution.
5. The use of un-balanced diet.
6. Non-availability of clean drinking water.
7. Indifferent attitude toward cleanliness.

4. The Environmental Problems

Pakistan is an important third world country. Here the population is increasing day by day, due to which environmental pollution is also increasing. Environment means surroundings and pollution means such unhealthy changes taking place in air, soil, water and environment, which badly affect human and animal lives. These changes are called Environmental Pollution. The factors affecting the environment include the increase in population and expansion of cities. In urban areas, the establishment of industries also results in increase in dust and smoke. Large numbers of factories are polluting the environment and causing complicated diseases. The rapid increase in motor vehicles and the emission of smoke makes the air poisonous.

Similarly, the rubbish thrown all around and the filth oozing out of the gutters is also polluting the environment.

The environmental pollution is causing some extremely negative effects on the human health. Therefore, for providing a clean environment, it is necessary that the vehicles emitting smoke should be banned. The rubbish heaps are removed, the industries are shifted from the cities and the environment in the cities is made free from noise. Above all, the rural migration towards the urban areas must be stopped.

5. Problems of Education

Education is a must for everyone because without it no society can prosper or make progress. The developed nations have made arrangements that each and every individual gets the basic education. Therefore, in this regard, they have considered it essential that the population of the country is brought in accordance with the natural resources of the country. So that everyone gets the basic education.

Therefore, these countries have kept the population under control by adopting proper measures. Pakistan is also one of those countries where there is no balance between the population and the resources. Per capita income is very low. Due to the increase in the number of family members the standard of living is getting from bad to worse. Therefore, parents are unable to give even the basic education to their children.



Send all children to school

Due to the lack of educational facilities in our country, the literacy rate even after more than 70 years of the creation of Pakistan is only 50 per cent. As a result, majority of the people are quite unaware about the different problems of life. Lawlessness, murder, theft, and social evils are on the increase due to the absence of education. The solution to all our problems lie in the promotion of education and increase in the literacy rate.

6. Human Values

The reason for the increase in population also includes social set up and human values. The rapid growth in the population is the cause of many social, political and economic problems. The social structure of every country is based on some ethical values. These values are decided by the country's religion, history, and its geographical and physical features. If a country's population gets out of control then these social and ethical values get disturbed. Pakistan is an ideological country. Due to increase in population our ethical and human values are declining. The increase in population has almost finished the concept of joint family system. Like this, the feelings of brotherhood, unity, mutual cooperation, are becoming

weak. Early-age marriages, the desires for the birth of a male child, the un-necessary dominance of man in the households are not only the causes of increase in population, but are mainly responsible for destroying many ethical and social values.

The rapid growth in population is resulting in unethical behaviour and crime. Theft, hoarding of goods, bribery, and drug addiction and moral degeneration is rising because the available resources are insufficient to meet the requirements of the growing population. There is an immediate need for bringing an end to these social evils. For which promotion of education is extremely essential. The social organizations should work for bringing reforms in their localities. Crime should be controlled and above all, the Islamic ethical system should be introduced at a faster pace. The time honoured human values should be respected and obeyed. Undue influence of alien cultures should be avoided for safeguarding social values.

Exercise

A. Answer the following questions:-

1. State the division of population in the world.
2. Which are the densely populated areas of the world? Discuss in detail.
3. State the reasons for high or low population in Pakistan.
4. Discuss the meanings of the words literate and illiterate.
5. What is meant by migration? State its effects.
6. State the effects of increase in population on human resources.
7. Write a note on the transportation problems of Pakistan.
8. State the problems related to health and hygiene.
9. State the problems that you face in your surroundings.

B. Write 'C' if the statement is correct and 'F' if it false:

1. In Pakistan and other Asian countries the population influx is from urban areas to the rural areas.
2. Development is only possible when women are educated.
3. Literacy gives rise to many social evils.
4. Information Technology is the need of the present day world.
5. Growth in population has created many problems for the developing nations.

C. Fill in the blanks with suitable words:

- 1. Illiterate people are a burden on _____
- 2. _____ should be given representation in all fields of life.
- 3. _____ is the most important human value.
- 4. Environment pollution is causing severe damage to _____.
- 5. About _____ per cent population of Pakistan lives in poorly made houses.

Activities

- + Show the problems that arise due to the heavy traffic on a chart. Also discuss in class some corrective measures that can be taken for the solution of these problems. A write-up of the measures suggested is sent to the local newspaper for public knowledge.
- + On an outline map of the world, show the areas, which are densely populated in one colour, and areas, which are sparsely populated, in another colour.
- + As you are aware that China and India are the thickly populated countries of the world. Find out the reasons of over population in these countries.



The resources, which are used for exchanging information or for sending messages from one place to another, are called means of communication. There are various ways and kinds of means of communication.

The old source of different signs through which the message is sent is called telegram. Apart from this these signs are also exchanged via audio aids, telephone and television. Due to communication satellites, fax and computers, this world has turned into a global house. Let us study a few of the important means of communication.

Telephone

Individuals, businessmen, and government functionaries use different types of telecommunication systems. Some communication systems, such as the telephone system, use a network of cables, wires, and switching stations for point-to-point communication.

In 1876 Alexander Graham Bell invented the telephone. This is a machine, which sends the human voice from one place to another. This exchange today takes place through communicational satellites. This process of exchange of messages has become speedy and sending messages to far-flung areas has become possible.

The telephone network is stable and reliable, because it uses its own wire system that is powered by low-voltage direct current

